

Advanced SWE: End Point Assessment (EPA)

Assessment Method 1: Capstone Project

Module title	Leading Digital Transformation		
Assessment title	Capstone Project Report		
Course credits	30		
Assessment No.	1 of 2	Deadline	
Format	Written report	Feedback due	
Word count	6,000 words	Weighting	50% of the overall EPA

Overview

The Capstone Project is a comprehensive work-based project that demonstrates your ability to apply digital technology solutions to address a real business need. This assessment method consists of two components: a written project report and a presentation with questions and answers. Through this project, you will showcase your specialist technical skills, strategic thinking, and ability to deliver business value through technology solutions. The project allows you to integrate and apply the knowledge, skills, and behaviors developed throughout your apprenticeship in a substantial piece of work with genuine business impact.

Project Requirements

Business Focus

Your project must address a genuine business need within your organization through a digital technology solution. This could be:

- A specific problem that needs solving
- A recurring issue that requires improvement
- An opportunity for innovation or enhancement

Project Scope

Your project should:

- Demonstrate your specialist pathway skills (Software Engineering, IT Consulting, etc.)
- Have clear business objectives and measurable outcomes
- Involve significant planning, including time and cost estimations
- Consider ethical, regulatory, and governance factors
- Require engagement with multiple stakeholders

Gateway Requirements

Before starting your EPA, you must:

1. Confirm you are ready for the EPA
2. Completed 100% OTJ
3. Have achieved English and mathematics qualifications in line with apprenticeship funding rules
4. Have completed and passed all required elements of the degree except the EPA
5. Submit a Capstone Project title and summary (max 500 words)

Component 1: Project Report (6,000 words $\pm 10\%$)

Your report must be completed after gateway and submitted by week 12 of the EPA period. It should include:

1. Introduction

- Overview of the business context and need
- Project aims and objectives
- Scope and boundaries

2. Project Scope

- Key performance indicators
- Stakeholder engagement approach
- Constraints and assumptions

3. Methodology

- Project management approach
- Research methodology
- Tools and techniques selected (with justification)
- Ethical considerations

4. Project Plan

- Timeline and milestones
- Resource requirements
- Risk assessment and mitigation strategies
- Budget considerations

5. Research and Findings

- Analysis of the business problem/opportunity
- Evaluation of potential solutions
- Literature review and industry best practices
- Data collection and analysis

6. Project Outcomes

- Implementation details
- Challenges encountered and how they were addressed
- Results achieved against KPIs
- Business impact assessment

7. Recommendations and Conclusions

- Critical evaluation of the project
- Recommendations for future development
- Lessons learned
- Strategic implications

8. Appendices

- KSB mapping to demonstrate how your project evidences the required knowledge, skills, and behaviors
- Supporting documentation
- References

Part 2: Presentation with Q&A (60 minutes)

You will deliver a 30-minute presentation followed by 30 minutes of questioning. Your presentation should include:

- Overview of the project
- Project scope (including KPIs)
- Summary of actions undertaken
- Project outcomes and how these were achieved
- Strategic recommendations

Your presentation materials must be submitted alongside your report by week 12 of the EPA period.



Module Letter Grade Translation

Your EPA grade is translated into a letter grade (A+ to U). At a minimum all Pass criteria needs to be met across AM1 plus a pass grade for AM2 to pass the EPA. This then translates to a minimum passing grade of D for the degree transcript. There are 25% Distinction criteria increments from a D to an A+ as set out below.

U	F	D	C	B	A	A+
Capstone Project not submitted on-time AND/OR Assessment does not take place	One or more KSBs marked as 'Fail' AND/OR AM2 Failed	All AM1 Pass Criteria met + AM2 is Passed	All AM1 Pass Criteria met + AM2 is Passed + 3 AM1 Distinction Criteria met	All AM1 Pass Criteria met + AM2 is Passed + 5 AM1 Distinction Criteria met	All AM1 Pass Criteria met + AM2 is Passed + 6 AM1 Distinction Criteria met	All AM1 Pass Criteria met + AM2 is Passed + All 9 AM1 Distinction Criteria met

Academic Standards Integration

Your capstone project assessment integrates academic competencies directly through the Knowledge, Skills, and Behaviors (KSBs) you must demonstrate. This means you don't need to worry about separate academic requirements - by successfully meeting the KSB criteria, you're automatically demonstrating the academic standards expected at degree level.

How Academic Competencies Are Built Into Your KSBs

Critical Analysis and Research Skills When you demonstrate KSBs like K54 (critically analyzing complex datasets) and K18 (using robust research techniques), you're showing the same critical thinking and research methodology skills expected in academic work. Your project report should demonstrate systematic inquiry, evidence-based reasoning, and sophisticated analysis.

Academic Writing and Communication KSBs K17 and S13 require you to synthesize information and communicate effectively to different audiences. This includes following academic conventions such as:

- Proper referencing and citation of sources
- Clear, structured argumentation

- Professional presentation of findings
- Appropriate academic language and style

Evidence-Based Decision Making Multiple KSBs (S1, K18, K5/S5) require you to justify your choices and approaches. This demonstrates the same evidence-based reasoning and logical argumentation that's central to academic work. You should:

- Support your decisions with credible evidence
- Compare and contrast different approaches
- Critically evaluate alternatives
- Draw well-reasoned conclusions

Ethical and Professional Standards KSB B3 ensures you consider ethical, legal, and regulatory requirements. This aligns with academic integrity principles and demonstrates your understanding of professional responsibility.

What This Means for Your Project

Focus on delivering a high-quality capstone project that thoroughly demonstrates all required KSBs. By doing so, you'll automatically meet the academic standards for this module. Your assessors will evaluate the same evidence for both your apprenticeship competencies and academic achievement, ensuring consistency and avoiding duplication.

Remember to:

- Use proper academic referencing throughout your report
- Demonstrate critical thinking in your analysis and decision-making
- Show evidence-based reasoning for all your choices
- Maintain professional and ethical standards throughout
- Communicate clearly and appropriately for your intended audience

This integrated approach means you can concentrate on producing excellent work that demonstrates your professional capabilities while meeting degree-level academic standards.

Key Points

- **Single Assessment:** One qualification cannot be achieved without the other - your EPA performance determines both your apprenticeship completion and your final module grade
- **Integrated Approach:** The same evidence demonstrates both professional competency (KSBs) and academic achievement
- **Clear Progression:** Letter grades reflect incremental achievement of distinction criteria, providing clear differentiation of performance levels



- **Academic Competencies:** These will be assessed holistically across your EPA, the examples on how to meet them through certain KSBs are provided as examples.

Summary

Focus on delivering a high-quality Capstone Project and Professional Discussion that demonstrates the required KSBs. Your performance will be assessed against both pass and distinction criteria, with your achievement level determining your final letter grade for this module and your overall apprenticeship completion.